

State-of-the-art Laboratories

NI technology for simulation and modeling

Under a project codenamed 'Chimera,' the students of R.V. College of Engineering, Bangalore, have developed the prototype of an energy-efficient hybrid electric vehicle based on the REVA electric vehicle platform using NI's LabVIEW software and CompactDAQ platform (a USB-based data acquisition system). A graphical user interface for in-vehicle data acquisition system was created on which the driver could monitor the car conditions like temperature, battery voltage and RPM. LabVIEW was also used to program the hardware, CompactDAQ, to charge the batteries and provide automatic engine switching functionality.



Karun Jain
academic technical
consultant, National
Instruments

Professional-grade equipment being inducted in labs

The institutes are making state-of-the-art professional-grade technology available to their students, to help them with a faster ramp-up when inducted in the industry. The focus is on the labs which carry professional-grade equipment present in the industry, the projects that directly impact the business on-the-ground and special interest groups (online or offline) that help students to become subject-matter experts.



Gautam Awasthi
general manager-
marketing, Electronic
Measurement Group,
Agilent Technologies
India

Optimised infrastructure for labs

As lab facilities became more widely used, AB Institute (name changed) was finding ways to reduce the recurring cost of lab infrastructure and maintenance cost. At the same time, it was not ready to compromise on quality and reliability. The college management asked SPI Engineers to suggest an optimal solution. Considering their budget, SPI Engineers suggested them products that are easy to handle for students, shockproof, rugged, latest in technology, medium-priced and come with long warranty. Taking a broader view, SPI successfully integrated the lab infrastructure to reduce functional as well as capital cost without compromising on the quality.



Sandeep Arora
director, SPI
Engineers

The Safe Side

Security on campus!

After facing a severe fire accident in 2006, the management of Somerville School, New Delhi, decided to install CCTV cameras at the campus. Howell designed and implemented the entire video security system along with school broadcasting system and world-class modular control room. Specific cameras and devices were used as per the requirement of the location: low-light dome cameras in classrooms, day/night cameras in outdoor locations, high-illumination masking IR cameras at the gate, speed dome cameras in playing fields, cascaded digital recorders in control rooms, digital control panels and keyboards in control rooms to talk, listen and monitor the activities in classrooms, low-heat-emitting and low-power-consuming LCDs in control rooms, and, last not the least, remote monitoring of outdoor cameras over the Internet.



Syed Ishiyas
business
development
manager, Howell
Protection Systems
(India) Pvt Ltd

Technology That Fits the Budget

Easy access to Microsoft world!

Microsoft runs a programme called MSDN Academic Alliance. Under this programme, annually about 1200 engineering colleges in India get access to the entire Microsoft software suite at a fraction of the normal cost. It is the easiest and the most inexpensive way for students and faculty in the technology and design fields to get the latest Microsoft software. The program enables the students to work with original Microsoft software in their day-to-day academic work and successfully execute IT projects, adding to their repertoire of skills. Microsoft's IT Academies programme answers multifarious needs of the technical colleges—e-learning, teacher enablement, digital content for globally relevant vocational and career certifications, virtual laboratories and e-books.



Rajeev Katyal
director-education,
Microsoft India

Large-format, low-cost printing

For announcement and teaching materials, Yong-Ji Junior High School of Taiwan needed a printer that could print large sizes, but maintenance and reliability were also important. As for every school, its budget was tight and resources slim, making the Epson Stylus Pro 7600 the educated choice. This printer uses simple programs and requires minimal training, yet gives fantastic results. PrintMagic and CorelDRAW are the main software as well as PhotoImpact, Word and PowerPoint running on Windows 98SE. The staff use digital cameras and scanners to add images, and they find that the printer itself is very user-friendly.

L.K. Vasudevan, business manager, LFP Products, Epson India